

Johanna Hölzl

PhD candidate in Sociology at the University of Mannheim
researching the quality of new data sources and methods for the social sciences

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 [johanna-hoelzl](#) |  [johanna-hoelzl](#) |  [0009-0002-4954-2209](#) |  Scholar

EXPERIENCE

University of Mannheim

Research Associate and Lecturer

2022 - now

Mannheim, Germany

- Empirical Research Course I and II (Spring and Fall 2023 and 2024)
- Data Collection Exercise Course (Fall 2022, 2023, 2024, and 2025)
- Bachelor Thesis Colloquium and Theses Supervision (Spring 2024, 2025, and 2026)

University of Mannheim and Mannheim Center for European Social Research

Research Associate

2021 - 2023

Mannheim, Germany

- Project "Integration research 2.0" on new data sources in migration and integration research
- Working on the methodological challenges, reliability and validity of Google Trends data

Leibniz-Institut für Bildungsverläufe e.V.

Research Associate

2021

Bamberg, Germany

- ReGes project on refugee's educational trajectories in Germany
- Support in the process of data collection and validation

Leibniz-Institut für Bildungsverläufe e.V.

Student Research Assistant

2015 - 2020

Bamberg, Germany

- ReGes project and other departments
- Support in the process of data collection, data analysis, and paper writing

University of Trento

Internship

2020

Trento, Italy

- Department of Sociology and Social Research
- Data cleaning and harmonization of longitudinal data

European Parliament

Internship

2017

Brussels, Belgium

- Office of Ismail Ertug, MEP
- Support in legislative, administrative, and organizational tasks in two committees

EDUCATION

University of Mannheim

PhD candidate

2021 - now

Mannheim, Germany

- Chair of Social Data Science and Methodology, Supervisor Prof. Florian Keusch
- Dissertation on "What We Can and Cannot Do: The Quality of New Data Sources and Methods in Social Science Research"

University of Bamberg and University of Trento

M.A. Sociology and Laurea Magistrale Sociology and Social Research

2018 - 2021

Bamberg, Germany and Trento, Italy

- Grade: 1.0 (GPA: 4.0), ranked 1st in cohort

University of Bamberg

B.A. Sociology

2014 - 2018

Bamberg, Germany

- Grade: 1.2 (GPA: 3.8)

PUBLICATIONS

- [1] Johanna Hölzl, Florian Keusch, John Collins (2026). **Where You Are Is What You Get! Inconsistencies of Digital Trace Data Across Download Locations**. *Social Science Computer Review* 0(0). DOI: 10.1177/08944393261469494
- [2] Johanna Hölzl, Florian Keusch, Christoph Sajons (2025). **The (mis)use of Google Trends data in the social sciences — A systematic review, critique, and recommendations**. *Social Science Research* 126(103099). DOI: 10.1016/j.ssresearch.2024.103099
- [3] Johanna Hölzl, Daria Szafran, Florian Keusch (2025). **Digitale Ungleichheiten in Deutschland**. *GESIS Data Archive*. DOI: 10.7802/2915
- [4] Johanna Hölzl, Marie-Lou Sohnus (2023). **Spotify API**. In *APIs for social scientists: A collaborative review*, edited by P. C. Bauer, C. Landesvatter, and L. Behrens.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS, POSTERS, AND INVITED TALKS

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| Meeting of the CS3 lab for Computational Survey and Social Science
Still problematic? Generalizability, validity, and reliability of API-based research (invited talk) | May 19, 2026 |
| General Online Research Conference 2026 (GOR 26)
"My (22m) Girlfriend (23f) Comes Home and Does Nothing" — Gendered Perceptions of Paid and Household Labor in Reddit Relationship Discussions over Time (poster presentation) | February 26-27, 2026
Cologne, Germany |
| 11th International Conference on Computational Social Science (IC²S²)
Where You Are Is What You Get? Sample Inconsistencies of Digital Trace Data Across Download Locations (poster presentation) | July 21-24, 2025
Norrköping, Sweden |
| 2025 Conference of the European Survey Research Association (ESRA)
Where You Are Is What You Get? Sample Inconsistencies of Digital Trace Data Across Download Locations (presentation) | July 14-18, 2025
Utrecht, Netherlands |
| General Online Research Conference 2025 (GOR 25)
Where You Are Is What You Get? Sample Inconsistencies of Google Trends Data Across Download Locations (presentation) | March 31-April 02, 2025
Berlin, Germany |
| 79th Annual Conference of the American Association for Public Opinion Research (AAPOR)
Where You Are Is What You Get? Sample Inconsistencies of Google Trends Data Across Download Locations (poster presentation) | May 15-17, 2024
Atlanta, USA |
| General Online Research Conference 2023 (GOR 23)
What do racists google? A systematic approach to selecting and validating Google Trends data using the example of xenophobic attitudes (presentation) | September 20-22, 2023
Kassel, Germany |
| GESIS course on "Data Science Tools for Survey Researchers"
The (mis)use of Google Trends data in the social sciences - A systematic review, critique, and guidelines (invited talk) | August 22, 2023
Mannheim, Germany |
| 2023 Conference of the European Survey Research Association (ESRA)
Sustainable Trend or Trending Mayfly? A Systematic Literature Review and Guidelines on Using Google Trends Data for Social Science Research (presentation) | July 17-21, 2023
Milan, Italy |
| Research Plus by the German Society for Online Research (DGOF)
Wonach googeln Rassisten? Chancen und Herausforderungen von Google Trends Daten für die Forschung (invited talk) | June 12, 2023
Mannheim, Germany |
| 78th Annual Conference of the American Association for Public Opinion Research (AAPOR)
What do racists google? A systematic approach to selecting and validating Google Trends data using the example of xenophobic attitudes (presentation) | May 10-12, 2023
Philadelphia, USA |
| MZES Ethnic Diversity Spring Workshop
Use of Google Trends Data in Research on Migration and Integration (presentation) | May 30, 2022
Mannheim, Germany |

AWARDS

GESS Publication of the Year Award

2025

Graduate School of Economic and Social Sciences (GESS), University of Mannheim

- Awarded for the publication "The (mis)use of Google Trends data in the social sciences A systematic review, critique, and recommendations"
- Endowed with 1000€

ABS² Preis für Abschlussarbeiten

2022

Alumni-Verein der Bamberger Soziologie und Survey-Statistik (ABS² e.V.)

- Awarded the price for the best Master thesis for "Additionally disadvantaged? The effect of technological change on the impact of a migration background on labor market outcomes across Europe"
- Endowed with 200€

COMMUNITY ACTIVITIES AND SERVICE

Peer Review

2022 - now

Conferences and Journals including Social Science Computer Review, Sociological Methods & Research, Social Sciences & Humanities Open, PLOS One, Survey Methods: Insights from the Field, AAPOR, and ESRA



Deputy Equal Opportunities Officer for the Social Sciences

2022 - now

University of Mannheim

- Appointment committee member for new social science professorships
- Co-organization of workshops on diversity and equality in research and teaching at the University of Mannheim

Conference Co-Organizer

2025

Mannheim Center for European Social Research

- Hybrid conference on "Novel Data Sources, New Methods and Computational Approaches for Understanding Discrimination and Bias"
- Co-organized with Nicole Schwitter, Daria Szafran, and Johanna Gereke

Organizing Committee Member of DataFest Germany

2024 and 2026

University of Mannheim

- Part of the organizing committee of a Hackathon for ~70 students

Conference Session Organizer

2023

10th ESRA Conference, Milan, Italy

- Session on Applications, Potentials, and Challenges when Using Google Trends in Combination or as Substitute for Surveys
- Co-organized with Florian Keusch

SKILLS

- **Programming Languages:** R, Python, Stata
- **Software:** Version control with Git, LaTeX, Unipark, MAXQDA
- **Languages:** German (Native proficiency), English (Business fluent), French (Fluent), Italian (Basics)